

Jason Herring

Design Technologist / Principal — Creative Engineer

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SUMMARY

Principal-level design technologist who ships — I write the code and direct the creative. 20+ years working at the seam of design and engineering, now leading AI prototyping on Intuit's Foresight team: conversational and voice interfaces, real-time personality engines, and agentic systems that move from speculative demo to shipped product. Recently shipped Intuit Labs (public beta to 1M+ users) and Delphi (delphi.intuit.com).

CORE SKILLS

Design Engineering & Creative Technology · Conversational & Voice AI · Generative AI, LLMs, RAG & Prompt Engineering · Agentic / Multi-Agent Systems · Real-Time Voice Pipelines (Vapi, LiveKit, Hume, HeyGen) · Rapid Prototyping & High-Fidelity Provocation · Design Systems & Interaction Design (Figma) · TypeScript · React · Next.js · Node.js · Python · Real-Time Systems & API Design · Executive Demos & Design Leadership

EXPERIENCE

Intuit — Senior Staff Design Technologist, Foresight (AI)

Apr 2024 – Present

Mountain View, CA · Promoted Staff → Senior Staff; served as Group Manager (Feb–Jun 2026) before returning to a senior IC leadership track to keep building. Key builder on Foresight, a 100+ person AI innovation team reporting into the Chief AI Officer org.

- **Shipped Intuit Labs**, a public beta live to **1M+ international users** with rollout to all of QuickBooks underway — the surface that turns AI innovation prototypes into shipping product.
- **Launched Delphi** (delphi.intuit.com), an AI business advisor that turns QuickBooks data into forward-looking recommendations.
- Designed and built a real-time AI personality engine from scratch — natural language, emotional intelligence, and embodied avatars — on ultra-low-latency voice pipelines (Vapi, Hume, LiveKit, HeyGen).
- Delivered flagship demos at executive forums and summits that shifted how leadership invests in AI as a product medium.
- Built org-wide AI-literacy workshops (Demystifying Python, Shipping Conversations, AI Avatars & Voice), seeding hands-on fluency across teams.

Aleph — Director of Design & Technology

Mar 2020 – Apr 2024

San Francisco, CA · Creative and technical leadership for an enterprise development studio (React, React Native, Node, WordPress).

- Grew annual revenue **85%+** over four years through new-client acquisition and expanded scopes.
- Directed a Helix clinical-trials mobile app — notifications, dashboards, and protocol-compliance tools — lifting user-acquisition success **22%**.
- Built and led a team of 8 engineers and 3 designers; introduced AI workflows (ChatGPT, Midjourney, Stable Diffusion) into design and delivery.

KQED — Director of Digital Design & Development

Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

San Francisco, CA · Owned design and engineering for Northern California's largest public-media organization.

- Led the multi-year KQED.org redesign and re-platformed a large WordPress CMS to GCP Kubernetes (canary deploys, instant rollbacks), powering hundreds of thousands of articles and partner feeds (NPR, Apple News, Google News).
- Shipped automated audio workflows for Alexa, Google Assistant, and NPR One; built real-time 2018 election infrastructure across every Bay Area county.

KQED — Lead UX Designer

Jan 2015 – Aug 2018

San Francisco, CA

- Redesigned KQED Radio, News, Arts, Science, and the homepage (persistent audio player, real-time trending); election dashboard drew **1M+ views** on 2016 election night.
- Shipped one of public media's first single-page apps — the 2016 Voter Guide (WordPress → Elasticsearch + React) — adopted as a model across NPR member stations.

OrdinaryKids — Founder & Creative Director

Jan 2001 – Jan 2015

San Francisco, CA · Founded and ran an award-winning creative studio for 13 years — a small team pioneering the creative use of technology for brand expression, and a hub of the SF interactive design scene.

- Pioneered early Flash and creative-technology work — interactive brand expression that set a bar across sport, skate, fashion, music, and architecture.
- Delivered dozens of projects for **Nike and Adidas** (including skateboarding), MoMA, Stüssy, HUF, Tracy Chapman / Elektra, and Aesop Rock — from an animated coloring-book experience for Tracy Chapman to the “None Shall Pass” music video.
- Ran a small, high-output team that became a hub of the San Francisco design scene and launched a generation of Bay Area design careers.

DualForces — Partner & Creative Director

Sep 2010 – Dec 2013

San Francisco, CA · Concurrent with OrdinaryKids.

- Creative-directed the Nike Free visual center — the first public use of real Nike+ data in a campaign — and ran the Nike FuelBand NYC activation (60+ events in 90 days).

EDUCATION

University of South Florida — English Literature

Hillsborough Community College — Associate of Arts

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

How Magazine, Best of Show (Interactive Annual) · FWA Site of the Day (multiple) · Communication Arts Interactive Annual · Featured in Taschen's History of Web Design